

1 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

First-sound picture hunt

What we are practising

Listen for initial sounds in familiar words.

What you need

Paper / Crayons

Use spoken words without pictures.

Before you begin

Draw sun, sock and moon; say each word naturally.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Say “sun” and notice its first /s/ sound.
2. Name the other pictures and choose one starting the same way.
3. Draw another matching object, such as soap, and say its name.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Do sun and moon start with the same sound?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

The lost hat story order

What we are practising

Explain event order using connecting words.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Act out the events instead.

Before you begin

Draw four panels: hat on head; wind blows it; hat in bush; child retrieves it.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Describe the pictures in a mixed order.
2. Ask the child to point to first, next, then and last.
3. Retell the story and explain why retrieving follows losing.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which picture shows why the hat moved?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Find the rhyming friend

What we are practising

Notice rhyme through spoken examples.

What you need

No materials

Draw objects to support the spoken words.

Before you begin

Say familiar words aloud; reading is unnecessary.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Say “cat, hat” and emphasise the shared ending.
2. Ask which rhymes with cat: hat or sun.
3. Try “boat, coat”, then invite another rhyme or playful invented word.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which ending sounds alike?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Letter shapes in a name

What we are practising

Recognise a selected letter in meaningful words.

What you need

Paper / Pencil / Book with clear print

An adult writes three short examples.

Before you begin

Write the child's name and choose a letter; show M and m if using "Mona".

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Point to the letter and trace its shape in the air.
2. Write it large, then find it in two familiar words.
3. Compare the examples and circle or point to the letter.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Does the letter always look identical?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Interview a family expert

What we are practising

Ask relevant questions and retell an answer.

What you need

Paper / Pencil for optional picture notes

Interview an adult pretending to be a gardener.

Before you begin

Choose a willing adult and topic, such as plant care.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Choose two questions: "What do you do?" and "What helps you?"
2. Ask, listen and draw one detail from each answer.
3. Tell another listener something learned and check it with the interviewee.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What new question follows from that answer?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Find the last sound

What we are practising

Hear a final consonant in a spoken word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Say “bus” slowly. Does it end with /b/ or /s/?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Join the spoken sounds

What we are practising

Blend three consonant-vowel-consonant sounds into a word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

An adult says s-uh-n, using the short “uh” sound in sun. Which word appears when you join the sounds?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Why did Sam take a coat?

What we are practising

Link an action to an explicitly stated reason.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“It was cold outside, so Sam took a coat.” Why did Sam take it?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Put the words in order

What we are practising

Arrange words into a meaningful simple sentence.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Arrange “the / opens / door / Hana” into a sentence about Hana.

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A mark for a question

What we are practising

Choose the end punctuation for a direct question.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which mark ends “Where is my shoe”: a full stop or a question mark?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Yesterday's action word

What we are practising

Notice how an action word changes for past time.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Finish: "Today I walk. Yesterday I ____." Choose walked or walking.

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The word that joins two things

What we are practising

Use an additive connecting word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“I packed a book ____ a pencil.” Which word joins both items: and or but?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Which word means enormous?

What we are practising

Choose a simple synonym in context.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“The enormous elephant filled the picture.” Does enormous mean very big or very small?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Choose a useful picture caption

What we are practising

Match a caption to the stated visual detail.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Imagine a picture of a girl watering a plant. Which caption fits: “A girl waters a plant” or “A girl rides a bike”?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Whose scarf is it?

What we are practising

Identify ownership from a short sentence.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“Rami lent his scarf to Noor.” Whose scarf is it, even while Noor wears it?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A sentence needs its action

What we are practising

Complete a sentence with a fitting action word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Complete “The baby ____ peacefully” with sleeps or chair.

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Two words make a new word

What we are practising

Build meaning from smaller meaningful parts.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

In English, rain + coat makes raincoat. Is a raincoat worn to help keep rain off or to tell the time?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

One sentence, two listeners

What we are practising

Adapt a simple message to address more than one person.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

You say “Please sit” to one friend. Can you use those same English words for two friends?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The clue after “but”

What we are practising

Understand a contrast in a short sentence.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“I wanted to play outside, but it rained.” Did the weather match the plan or make it harder?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Choose a title for the mini story

What we are practising

Identify the central event for a short title.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“A kitten hid under a chair. Sara looked, found it and brought it home.” Which title fits better: “Finding the Kitten” or “Baking Bread”?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. First-sound picture hunt

A little hint

Listen to the sound, not the letter's alphabet name.

Answer / what to notice

Sun and sock start with /s/; moon starts with /m/. Soap begins with /s/.

Words can share an initial sound while having different meanings.

Make it easier

Offer only two pictures with clearly different starting sounds.

Take it further

Find three words beginning with another sound.

Another day, away from the screen

Listen for the chosen sound in familiar object names.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. The lost hat story order

A little hint

Look for the wind before the hat lands in the bush.

Answer / what to notice

Hat on head, wind blows it, hat lands in bush, child retrieves it.

Cause-and-effect clues connect the events.

Make it easier

Use three events, leaving out the bush.

Take it further

Add an ending that follows the earlier events.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell a real event from the day in four parts.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Find the rhyming friend

A little hint

Say both words slowly without changing their usual sounds.

Answer / what to notice

Cat rhymes with hat; boat rhymes with coat. Meanings need not match.

Rhyme uses ending sounds; sharing a first letter is not enough.

Make it easier

Repeat a rhyming pair together before choosing.

Take it further

Make a three-word chain; identify any invented words.

Another day, away from the screen

Listen for rhyme in a familiar song or poem.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Letter shapes in a name

A little hint

Show uppercase M beside lowercase m.

Answer / what to notice

Find the selected letter; show its uppercase and lowercase forms when needed.

A letter can have more than one visual form.

Make it easier

Match identical handwritten examples only.

Take it further

Find the letter in a new word and name its position.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a name label for a drawing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Interview a family expert

A little hint

Use what, how or why to invite a fuller answer.

Answer / what to notice

Accurately retelling a relevant detail meets the task; kindly clarify misunderstandings.

Follow-up questions build on what the speaker said.

Make it easier

Ask one question and repeat its answer together.

Take it further

Invent a follow-up question without prompting.

Another day, away from the screen

Add a caption to a picture about the interview.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. Find the last sound

A little hint

Stretch the very end: bussss.

Answer / what to notice

The /s/ sound.

The /b/ sound starts bus; /s/ is last.

Make it easier

An adult says the two sounds separately.

Take it further

Does “yes” end with the same sound?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Join the spoken sounds

A little hint

Slide from one sound into the next.

Answer / what to notice

Sun.

Blending the three sounds makes sun; letters are not named aloud.

Make it easier

The adult blends it very slowly first.

Take it further

Blend /m/ /a/ /p/, using the short vowel in map.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Why did Sam take a coat?

A little hint

Look at the words before “so”.

Answer / what to notice

Because it was cold outside.

The sentence gives cold weather as the reason; other reasons are unnecessary.

Make it easier

Choose between cold weather and a hot bath.

Take it further

Tell a new sentence using “because”.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. Put the words in order

A little hint

Who does the action? What does she open?

Answer / what to notice

Hana opens the door.

Hana is the person, opens is the action, and door receives it.

Make it easier

Give “Hana opens” as the beginning.

Take it further

Add a word describing the door.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. A mark for a question

A little hint

The speaker wants an answer.

Answer / what to notice

A question mark: Where is my shoe?

A direct written question normally ends with a question mark.

Make it easier

Show . and ? while reading aloud.

Take it further

Make a statement about the shoe and choose its end mark.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. Yesterday's action word

A little hint

Yesterday is already over.

Answer / what to notice

Yesterday I walked.

Walked refers to an action in the past.

Make it easier

The adult reads both complete versions.

Take it further

Change "Today I play" to yesterday.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. The word that joins two things

A little hint

Both things are included; there is no contrast.

Answer / what to notice

And: a book and a pencil.

And adds another item; but usually introduces a contrast.

Make it easier

Point to two imagined items as you say “and”.

Take it further

Join three things in one sentence.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. Which word means enormous?

A little hint

It takes up lots of space in the picture.

Answer / what to notice

Very big.

Enormous describes a large size in this sentence.

Make it easier

Use wide and narrow hand gestures.

Take it further

Name another word for very small.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. Choose a useful picture caption

A little hint

Find the action that matches the picture.

Answer / what to notice

A girl waters a plant.

A caption should describe what the picture shows.

Make it easier

Act out watering without water.

Take it further

Add one imagined detail and change the caption to match.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Whose scarf is it?

A little hint

Lending does not mean giving away forever.

Answer / what to notice

Rami's scarf.

The scarf belongs to Rami; Noor is borrowing it.

Make it easier

Ask who owned it before lending it.

Take it further

Explain the difference between lending and giving.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. A sentence needs its action

A little hint

Choose something a baby can do.

Answer / what to notice

The baby sleeps peacefully.

Sleeps names an action; chair names an object and does not fit this gap.

Make it easier

Act out sleeping.

Take it further

Replace sleeps with another action that fits.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. Two words make a new word

A little hint

Use the meanings of the two parts.

Answer / what to notice

To help keep rain off.

Raincoat combines rain and coat; the first part tells us the purpose of the coat.

Make it easier

Explain coat first, then add rain.

Take it further

What might a toothbrush be for?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. One sentence, two listeners

A little hint

English “you” can mean one or more people.

Answer / what to notice

Yes. “Please sit” can address one friend or two.

This English command stays the same whether one or two people are listening.

Make it easier

Ask the adult to demonstrate one listener, then two.

Take it further

How could you make it clear you mean both friends?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. The clue after “but”

A little hint

But introduces a change from what was hoped.

Answer / what to notice

It made the plan harder.

The sentence contrasts wanting outdoor play with rainy weather; it does not say what happened next.

Make it easier

Explain “but” as “here is a problem with that plan”.

Take it further

Add a possible next sentence without claiming it was stated.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Choose a title for the mini story

A little hint

Think about what Sara does in the story.

Answer / what to notice

Finding the Kitten.

The main event is finding the kitten; no bread is mentioned.

Make it easier

Retell the story with three gestures.

Take it further

Suggest another short title supported by the story.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.